

r/artificial

Meta AI has upto ten times the carbon footprint of a google search

Posted by u/intensivetreats • • 0 points • 59 comments

Just wondered how peeps feel about this statistic. Do we have a duty to boycott for the sake of the planet?

Comments

u/ZealousidealTurn218 • 1 points • 2025-04-08 03:12 UTC

Using current hardware to make a comparatively meaningful negative climate impact would be prohibitively expensive. Datacenter GPUs cost about as much as a car but emit 100x less, so don't worry about it until you're spending tens of thousands per month on AI.

u/ezjakes • 1 points • 2025-04-08 02:13 UTC

Naw

u/CovertlyAI • 1 points • 2025-04-07 17:14 UTC

Yikes — we're making smarter machines at the cost of a dumber planet.

u/mashotatos • 1 points • 2025-04-06 07:11 UTC

I guess ads are at least 10x cheaper than an answer

u/youngpeezy • 1 points • 2025-04-06 04:05 UTC

Everyone here seems to just equate environmental impact of AI with the energy used in compute. It's not only that, it's also the emissions associated with the exponential increase in GPUs, data centers, etc. I work in sustainability for tech and I have serious concerns that new clean energy sources won't come online as fast as big tech wants to use more energy and build more infrastructure. I only hope models like deepseek and a possible recession slowing purchasing of capital goods inspires tech companies to slow down the building and focus on more efficient models. This era of tech could be a truly devastating inflection point in an already alarming climate emergency we cannot forget we are in.

u/theturbod • 1 points • 2025-04-05 22:55 UTC

Sorry, we're not sacrificing technological progress just because of a bit of carbon

u/md24 • 1 points • 2025-04-05 12:35 UTC

No one cares about carbon footprint. It's bullshit made up to pass blame onto consumer.

u/Ri711 • 2 points • 2025-04-05 06:48 UTC

Yeah, that stat definitely makes you think. AI's power comes with a cost, and it's easy to forget the environmental side when we're just chatting with a bot or generating images. I'm not sure boycotting is the answer, but maybe pushing for greener infrastructure and more efficient models is the way to go.

u/graybeard5529 • 1 points • 2025-04-05 06:11 UTC

Data centers & AI computational centers are moving towards [SMR]
(<https://www.iaea.org/newscenter/news/what-are-small-modular-reactors-smrs>) small modular reactors --nuclear power.

Little carbon footprint, not in my neighborhood resistance. No reason these installations could be built in semi-rural isolated areas where there is a good surface or ground water-source.

u/RivRobesPierre • 1 points • 2025-04-05 03:16 UTC

Good info.